

Pet emergency financial planning — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

MAP YOUR PET'S SPECIFIC RISK

- ☐ **Call your veterinarian and ask specifically what the top two or three conditions your pet's breed is most likely to face, since your vet can answer this question in under a minute and give you personalized risk guidance.:** Call your veterinarian and ask specifically what the top two or three conditions your pet's breed is most likely to face, since your vet can answer this question in under a minute and give you personalized risk guidance.
- ☐ **Search breed-specific health databases like the AKC Canine Health Foundation or the Companion Animal Parasite Council to find typical cost ranges for the three highest-cost conditions your breed faces.:** Search breed-specific health databases like the AKC Canine Health Foundation or the Companion Animal Parasite Council to find typical cost ranges for the three highest-cost conditions your breed faces.
- ☐ **Complete the three-question risk profile exercise by documenting your pet's species, breed, and age, listing their breed's highest-cost conditions with typical price ranges, and circling which condition is most likely given your pet's current health.:** Complete the three-question risk profile exercise by documenting your pet's species, breed, and age, listing their breed's highest-cost conditions with typical price ranges, and circling which condition is most likely given your pet's current health.
- ☐ **Calculate how far your current emergency savings would actually stretch by comparing your available funds against the specific cost ranges you found for your pet's three highest-risk conditions.:** Calculate how far your current emergency savings would actually stretch by comparing your available funds against the specific cost ranges you found for your pet's three highest-risk conditions.

BUILD YOUR FINANCIAL SAFETY NET

- ☐ **Set a realistic emergency fund target by subtracting your current savings from your highest-risk emergency cost range, using the specific numbers from your personalized risk profile instead of vague savings advice.:** Set a realistic emergency fund target by subtracting your current savings from your highest-risk emergency cost range, using the specific numbers from your personalized risk profile instead of vague savings advice.
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- **Evaluate pet insurance or alternative options like CareCredit before you need them, so you can compare premiums, coverage limits, and exclusions objectively rather than scrambling for coverage during a crisis.:** Evaluate pet insurance or alternative options like CareCredit before you need them, so you can compare premiums, coverage limits, and exclusions objectively rather than scrambling for coverage during a crisis.

- **Set up automatic transfers to a dedicated pet emergency savings account, even if you start with a small amount, so you begin building your safety net before an emergency forces you into debt.:** Set up automatic transfers to a dedicated pet emergency savings account, even if you start with a small amount, so you begin building your safety net before an emergency forces you into debt.

- **List all available payment options for your area, including in-house payment plans, CareCredit, Scratchpay, and negotiating directly with your vet, so you have a written plan for each option before an emergency happens.:** List all available payment options for your area, including in-house payment plans, CareCredit, Scratchpay, and negotiating directly with your vet, so you have a written plan for each option before an emergency happens.

PLAN YOUR EMERGENCY RESPONSE OPTIONS

- **Prepare a negotiation script that includes your specific payment timeline and amount you can afford, then present it to your vet billing department calmly when discussing a bill you cannot pay upfront.:** Prepare a negotiation script that includes your specific payment timeline and amount you can afford, then present it to your vet billing department calmly when discussing a bill you cannot pay upfront.

 - **Accept that guilt is a normal emotional response to an expensive pet emergency rather than a sign of poor ownership, and redirect that energy into executing the concrete financial steps you have already prepared.:** Accept that guilt is a normal emotional response to an expensive pet emergency rather than a sign of poor ownership, and redirect that energy into executing the concrete financial steps you have already prepared.

 - **Schedule an annual review of your pet emergency plan each year on your pet's birthday, using your completed risk profile as a baseline to reassess whether your savings target and protection measures still match your pet's current health status.:** Schedule an annual review of your pet emergency plan each year on your pet's birthday, using your completed risk profile as a baseline to reassess whether your savings target and protection measures still match your pet's current health status.
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Check the Full Guide: This step is described in detail in the companion guide — open [pet-emergency-fund-plan.md](#) and review the relevant section.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.